

Global Healthcare: 47th Annual Global Healthcare Conference — Notes from GS Investment Banker Panel

47th Annual Global Healthcare Conference

June 8–10, 2026 | Florida

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In conjunction with our 47th Annual Global Healthcare Conference, we hosted a panel featuring GS investment bankers who cover Biopharma, Life Sciences Tools & Diagnostics, Medtech, M&A, and Europe Healthcare titled *A Conversation with GS Investment Bankers: The State & Outlook for the Healthcare Sector, M&A, and Capital Markets*. The panel discussed the broader equity markets, capital raising environments and M&A across geographies, including the heightened activity in China's biopharma sector and impacts from AI. We offer high-level takeaways within.

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Key Takeaways

Biopharma

- On market sentiment, the panelist spoke to a constructive backdrop of increased M&A activity (~\$100bn YTD vs \$50bn in 2025), increased equity issuance, and receptivity to deals, though noted a large degree of volatility remains driven by broad economic, geographic, and regulatory uncertainty. The panelist also pointed to an emerging thematic surrounding midcap M&A whereby large biotech acquirers are actively pursuing smaller deals, engaging early, incorporating CVRs, and targeting niche therapeutic areas outside the typical large pharma scope.
- As it relates to China, the panelist noted innovation from China remains a highly polarizing topic, where some view it as an existential threat while others see it as an attractive opportunity offering high-quality innovation, low cost of capital, and high throughput on clinical trials (via faster patient recruitment and time to approval). The panelist noted mutual interest from both parties, where Chinese

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entities want access to US markets and US strategics recognize value in acquiring affordable assets. At the same time, China's booming biotech engine is also forcing US innovators to improve operational efficiencies in the US.

- On sector outlook, the panelist pointed to AI as a key tailwind and persistent regulatory/policy uncertainty as a key headwind. While it is likely too early to gauge how AI implementation is translating to higher revenues, reduced lab headcount, or accelerated clinical trials, the panelist pointed to various efficiencies in administrative work (i.e., legal and regulatory filings), though caveating these may be partially offset by high deployment costs. The panelist also noted AI adoption in biopharma is structurally constrained by the speed of liability.

Medtech

- On market sentiment, the panelist noted the sector remains largely out of favor relative to the broader market — despite solid underlying fundamentals, companies are not being rewarded. At the same time, the panelist expects momentum is likely to return as large-cap players reset expectations and establish a beat and raise pattern. On M&A dynamics, the panelist noted M&A dollar volume has remained elevated over the past three years, with a shift toward commercial-stage assets where execution risk is lower. Furthermore, with existential pricing overhangs, there is greater focus on getting comfortable with terminal value.
- Regarding AI applications, while AI could aid in patient identification and diagnosis, the panelist expects hurdles in integrating AI in medical devices and establishing physician trust in these products, both of which could take time to play out.
- On sector outlook, the panelist highlighted strong sector fundamentals and recovering valuations as tailwinds and lengthening innovation/development timelines as a sector headwind.

Life Sciences Tools & Diagnostics

- Regarding market sentiment within tools, while we are still seeing compression in the sector, the panelist noted an increasing focus on portfolio augmentation to build moats and drive long-term value, and that this is likely to drive a near-term inflection in the sector. The panelist also highlighted strength in high-growth diagnostic segments, such as oncology, that are successfully transitioning to profitability.
- On AI integration, the panelist highlighted AI's utilization in tools to optimize lab efficiency, workflow, and data-driven throughput, while in diagnostics, AI is critical for capturing longitudinal data, building data moats, and accelerating product innovation.
- On sector outlook, the panelist called out AI-driven opportunities as a tailwind and regulatory hurdles and NIH funding volatility as headwinds.

Europe Healthcare

- The panelist highlighted robust M&A activity driven by larger deals, increased deal flow, higher willingness to transact, and P2P transactions. On MFN impact, the panelists noted pricing headwinds have driven contractions in ex-US licensing deals

and perceptions of heightened downside risk. As companies are increasingly forced to weigh risks to pricing in their global portfolio strategy, this has created friction in deal processes as companies see impacts to launch sequencing and delayed timelines. Finally, while the EU remains a reliable source of innovation, the panelist noted many companies face scalability bottlenecks due to limited access to capital (especially relative to the US), which is driving a strong push for scale via bolt-on M&A and consolidation.

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